Name: _____ **Group:** _____ **Date:** _____

4 ESO · SEASONS & CELEBRATIONS · ROUTE PRO

Getting started

✏️ Paper worksheet: do the same activities as on the computer. Write your answers and circle the letter of the right option. Do it without notes the first time.

🎯 **My goal**

Before you start: think about your last recall or checkpoint. What do you want to get better at in this Learning Path?

_____

1 Recall

1. I'm shattered: I'm going to turn _____ early tonight.
2. I keep putting _____ my homework until the last minute.
3. My alarm went off, but I lay _____ for another twenty minutes.
4. I'm not a morning _____: I can't think before nine.
5. Weekends throw my sleep pattern completely out of _____.
6. Sticking to a routine requires a lot of _____ (DISCIPLINE).
7. Scrolling at night makes it _____ (NOTORIOUS) hard to fall asleep.
8. Hardly _____ I sat down when my phone rang. (1 word)

2 Autumn words

English	Meaning	Example
The turning year		
the nights draw in	it starts getting dark earlier in the evening	Once the clocks go back, the nights really draw in.
a nip in the air	a slight coldness in the weather	There's a nip in the air this morning.
crisp	cold, dry and fresh (weather); firm and fresh (leaves, food)	a crisp autumn morning
a cold snap	a sudden short period of very cold weather	The cold snap killed the last tomatoes.
an Indian summer	a period of unusually warm weather in autumn	We had an Indian summer in October.
dank	unpleasantly wet and cold	a dank November afternoon
to wane	to become gradually smaller or weaker (light, interest)	The light wanes by five o'clock.
Harvest and the land		
bountiful	producing large amounts	a bountiful harvest
to forage	to search for wild food	We foraged for mushrooms and chestnuts.
to gather in (the harvest)	to collect crops when they are ready	Farmers gathered in the grapes.

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English	Meaning	Example
russet	reddish-brown	russet leaves
mellow	soft, warm and gentle, not harsh	the mellow light of late October
to hibernate	to sleep through the winter	Hedgehogs hibernate in piles of leaves.
Mood and season		
wistful	sadly thinking about something you cannot have or that has passed	Autumn always makes me wistful.
to hunker down	to stay inside and prepare to wait for a long time	We hunker down at home when it gets cold.
cosy	comfortable, warm and relaxing	a cosy evening by the fire
the winter blues	a low mood some people feel when the days are short	Light lamps help with the winter blues.
seasonal affective disorder	a kind of depression linked to the dark months	SAD affects many people in northern countries.

Study them: cover the meaning column and define each word in your own words. Then complete the sentences without looking at the table.

1. Once the clocks go back, the nights really _____ in.
2. There's a _____ in the air: time to get the coats out.
3. We had an Indian _____: 25 degrees in mid-October.
4. On Sunday we _____ for mushrooms in the forest. (searched for wild food)
5. The harvest was _____ this year: the trees were full. (producing a lot)
6. The _____ light of late October is soft and golden.
7. Old photos always make my grandmother _____. (sad about the past)
8. When it gets cold, we _____ down at home with blankets.
9. Interest in the old customs is slowly _____ (becoming weaker).
10. A sudden, short spell of freezing weather: a cold _____.

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3 Reading: The autumn chat

In praise of the in-between season

Summer has a lobby and winter has a fan club, but autumn, for most people, is something that happens to them on the way to somewhere else. It arrives as a series of small inconveniences: a jumper retrieved from the back of a drawer, a bike ride home in unexpected darkness, the faint indignity of turning the heating on in October. We tend to describe it in terms of what it is taking away.

And yet the season has a stubborn way of insisting on itself. In Catalonia it does so with the smell of chestnuts roasting on street corners, in Britain with a sky full of fireworks on the fifth of November, in half the world with pumpkins grinning from doorsteps. It is striking how many of these customs involve fire or light. A cynic might say that people simply need an excuse to stay outside a little longer before the long hibernation. A more generous reading is that autumn is the season in which communities make a point of gathering precisely because the year is telling them to disperse.

There is also something honest about it. Summer promises that the good times will last; autumn makes no such claim. The light wanes, the leaves come down, and the dead, in many traditions, are given their night. Far from being morbid, this strikes me as a kind of grown-up tenderness. A culture that sets aside a day to remember the people it has lost, and then sits down to share chestnuts and sweet potatoes, has understood something about how grief and appetite live side by side.

I used to think of autumn as the year's waiting room. I have come round to the view that it is the only season that tells the truth.

1. What does the writer suggest with "Summer has a lobby and winter has a fan club"?
   a) Summer and winter are more political than autumn. **b)** Most people prefer winter to summer.
   c) Other seasons have enthusiastic supporters, whereas autumn is overlooked.
   d) Autumn is the most popular season.

2. The examples in the first paragraph (the jumper, the bike ride, the heating) show autumn as…
   a) a series of minor annoyances **b)** a time for exercise **c)** an expensive season
   d) a dangerous time of year

3. How does the writer treat the "cynic's" view of autumn customs?
   a) as offensive to people who celebrate
   b) as possible, but less convincing than a more generous interpretation **c)** as completely wrong
   d) as the only realistic explanation

4. What is the paradox in "communities make a point of gathering precisely because the year is telling them to disperse"?
   a) Communities are too large to gather in autumn.
   b) People come together just when the season pushes them apart. **c)** Autumn festivals are disappearing.
   d) People prefer to celebrate alone in autumn.

5. Why does the writer call autumn "honest"?
   a) Its weather is predictable. **b)** It has no commercial celebrations.
   c) It does not pretend that good things last forever. **d)** People tell the truth more in autumn.

6. What does "grown-up tenderness" refer to?
   a) parents caring for their children in winter **b)** the warmth of autumn colours
   c) avoiding the subject of death **d)** remembering the dead while also enjoying food together

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7. “I have come round to the view…” tells us that the writer…
   a) is still undecided **b)** is repeating someone else’s view **c)** has changed their mind over time
   d) has always held this opinion

8. Which phrase best describes the tone of the text?
   a) neutral and informative **b)** humorous and dismissive **c)** angry and critical
   d) reflective and gently persuasive

4 Listening: Halloween and the Castanyada

🎧 **Halloween and the Castanyada** · If you cannot listen to it, read transcript 1 at the end of the worksheet (twice, as if you were listening).

1. Why does the presenter open with a question (“where do two famous autumn celebrations come from?”)?
   a) to introduce a debate between the speakers **b)** to frame the whole episode around origins
   c) to advertise the next episode **d)** to test the listener’s knowledge

2. What does “here’s a surprise” assume about the audience?
   a) They associate Halloween only with pumpkins. **b)** They know a lot about Celtic history.
   c) They dislike turnips. **d)** They have never heard of Halloween.

3. The story of the bell ringers is introduced with “People say that…”. This signals that…
   a) historians have confirmed it **b)** it is the speakers’ own opinion
   c) it is a traditional explanation, not a proven fact **d)** it happened recently

4. Why does Emma mention that chestnuts and sweet potatoes are “easy to find”?
   a) to give a practical explanation alongside the traditional story
   b) to explain why they are cheap in shops today **c)** to contradict Sam **d)** to recommend a recipe

5. What is the function of the final line, “But they feel very different!”?
   a) to say which celebration is better **b)** to contrast shared origins with different modern experiences
   c) to admit the speakers disagree **d)** to correct a mistake made earlier

6. Which statement would the speakers most likely agree with?
   a) The Castanyada is older than Halloween. **b)** Halloween has no connection to remembering the dead.
   c) Traditions should never change. **d)** Traditions change as people move and circumstances change.

5 Real video: the mystery of autumn colours

A real popular-science video at native speed (PBS Terra), with a presenter, two forest scientists and people in the street. Watch it once for the main idea, then answer. Several questions test what the speakers imply, not only what they say.

🎧 **There’s One Thing About Fall Colors Scientists Can’t Explain** · YouTube video: your teacher will play it for you (youtube.com/watch?v=mPbU2XqIloE).

1. Why does the presenter mention “leaf peepers”?
   a) To show that autumn colour brings a lot of money into the region **b)** To explain how leaves are studied
   c) To introduce the scientists **d)** To make fun of tourists

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2. What does the presenter mean when he says that, technically, leaves don't change colour?
   a) The yellows and oranges were in the leaf all along, hidden by the green chlorophyll.
   b) Only red leaves really change colour. **c)** The colours are an optical illusion caused by autumn light.
   d) Leaves die before they change colour.

3. Why does the scientist call red leaves "counterintuitive"?
   a) Red is the rarest colour in nature. **b)** Red leaves fall earlier than yellow ones.
   c) The tree spends energy making a new pigment in leaves it is about to lose.
   d) Red pigment stops the leaf photosynthesising.

4. What might the red pigment do, according to the video?
   a) Store sugar for the winter. **b)** Attract birds that spread the tree's seeds.
   c) Keep the leaf warm on cold nights.
   d) Act as a sunscreen (and perhaps keep insects away) while the tree recovers nutrients from the leaf.

5. How is the Vermont foliage survey carried out?
   a) Tourists send in photographs. **b)** Satellites measure the colour every day.
   c) Observers estimate the percentage of colour and leaf drop by eye and agree on a figure.
   d) Leaves are collected and analysed in a laboratory.

6. What change has the survey found, and why?
   a) Autumn colour comes a little later, because temperature cues have become less predictable.
   b) Leaves fall earlier, because days are shorter. **c)** Colours are brighter, because there is more sun.
   d) There is no change at all.

7. Which weather gives the most spectacular colour?
   a) A long drought **b)** Hot days and warm nights
   c) Bright, dry days and cool nights that stay above freezing **d)** Heavy rain followed by a hard frost

8. How would you describe the tone of the ending?
   a) Dismissive of climate change. **b)** Strictly neutral, with no opinion.
   c) Alarmist: the forests will soon disappear.
   d) Concerned but reassuring: the changes will take decades, so there is time to act.

6 Speaking: plan your answer (no recording)

The question

"Autumn is a season people endure rather than enjoy." How far do you agree?

C2 Proficiency Speaking, Part 3 style: about two minutes alone. Here you only plan it.

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🧭 **Strategy**

Strategy · "How far do you agree?" is never yes or no. The examiner wants a position with a degree: *largely, up to a point, only if…* Decide your degree first; everything else follows from it.

Find the hidden word. Every statement has one word that does the work. Here it is *endure*: who endures autumn (commuters in the dark?) and who enjoys it (children on 31 October?). Splitting the people is an easy way to build a nuanced answer.

Use one concrete scene (your street on the night of the Castanyada, the first evening the heating goes on). One vivid example beats three general ones.

Your plan · Write notes, not full sentences: this is the thinking you would do in the exam's preparation time.

What comes to mind first? (15 seconds, everything)

Your degree of agreement, in one sentence

Your two strongest ideas and the scene you will use

Your order: degree → idea 1 + scene → idea 2 (the other side) → conclusion

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A model plan

(read it only after you have written your plan)

Degree: Up to a point: it depends on whose autumn we mean.
Idea 1 (agree): for adults it's endured: dark commutes, the heating bill, the winter blues.
Scene: 31 October in my street: chestnuts, children in costumes, grandparents on the doorstep. Nobody is enduring anything.
Idea 2 (turn): communities invented festivals precisely to make the season enjoyable; the customs are the answer to the problem.
Conclusion: we endure the weather, but we enjoy what we built to cope with it.

Phrases: *Up to a point… · It rather depends on… · Take…, for example. · That said,… · What it comes down to is…*

What would you change in your plan now? (one sentence)

🔁 **How did it go?**

What helped me most?

What do I need to review?

📚 Study guide: prepare for Checkpoint 1 and the final exam

How to study what you learn in this Learning Path, and practice that works like the checkpoint and looks like the exam. The answer key is at the end of each activity.

How to study

🧠 **Test yourself, don't reread**

Close your notes and try to remember: write the words, say the rule, answer the questions. Then check. Rereading and highlighting feel useful, but you remember much less.

Retrieval practice · Roediger & Karpicke 2006; Dunlosky et al. 2013

📅 **Spread it out**

Three short sessions of 15 minutes on different days work better than one long session the day before.

Spacing · Cepeda et al. 2006

🔀 **Mix it up**

Practise similar things together so you learn to choose the right one for each sentence.

Interleaving · Rohrer & Taylor 2007

✅ **Check and fix at once**

Mark your answers with the key straight away and write each wrong answer again, correctly.

Feedback · Hattie & Timperley 2007

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💬 Say why

For every answer, say the reason: “on, because it’s a date.” Explaining makes the rule stick.

Self-explanation · Dunlosky et al. 2013

😴 Sleep on it

Your brain stores what you learn while you sleep. A short self-test and a good night’s sleep beat studying late the night before.

Sleep and memory · Diekelmann & Born 2010

My plan

1. **Today** · Close this page and write from memory: five autumn words and two sentences about your routine. Then check.
2. **In 2–3 days** · Do “Practise for Checkpoint 1” below. Look at the key and write again what you got wrong.
3. **Before Checkpoint 1** · Go over the flashcards: only the ones you still miss.
4. **The week before the exam** · Do the exam-style practice in every Learning Path, then the Sample exam. Repeat only the parts you failed.

What comes up

Checkpoint 1 (LS1 and Learning Paths 1 and 2): short gaps, collocations and word formation, one question at a time, about 45 seconds each, no going back and no notes. You do it once, and you must stay on the page: if you leave it, it is sent. It opens the next Learning Path.
Final exam: the C2 version: listening for attitude and implication, a long reading, vocabulary (multiple-choice cloze and word formation), grammar (open cloze and key word transformations) and a formal letter.

Practise for Checkpoint 1

One question at a time · 45 s

It works like the real checkpoint: 10 questions, one at a time, about 45 seconds each, with no going back and no notes. This is only practice: nothing is sent, you can repeat it, and at the end you see your answers and the key.

On paper: cover the questions and uncover them one at a time, about 45 seconds each, with no going back.

1. In late October the clocks go back and the evenings draw _____.
2. I’m a creature _____ habit: I get up at 6.30 every day.
3. She is _____ (NOTORIOUS) late for everything.
4. Hardly _____ I got home when it started to pour.
5. Seasonal affective _____ makes some people low in winter.
6. The harvest was _____ (DISAPPOINT) this year.
7. I can’t get _____ to work until I’ve had breakfast.
8. We whipped _____ a quick dinner before the film.
9. The trees were a riot _____ colour.
10. Rarely _____ we see such a mild November.

Like the exam: Vocabulary

1 point · gaps 2 points

Choose the right word, or type it.

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1. The valley was ___ in a thick autumn fog. [1 point]

a) shrouded **b)** dressed **c)** stuffed **d)** packed

2. There's a definite ___ in the air this morning. [1 point]

a) nip **b)** chew **c)** pinch **d)** nibble

3. The _____ (SHORT) of the days affects my mood. [2 points]

4. Our routine is _____ (PREDICT), but I like it that way. [2 points]

Like the exam: Grammar 1 point · gaps 2 points

Choose the right form, or type it.

1. I started my homework as soon as I got home. SOONER → No _____ home than I started my homework. [2 points]

2. I rarely sleep in at the weekend. RARELY → _____ in at the weekend. [2 points]

3. Open cloze: I'm used _____ getting up early. [2 points]

4. Open cloze: Strange _____ it may seem, I love dark evenings. [2 points]

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📚 Study guide: answer key

Look at them only when you have finished each activity.

Practise for Checkpoint 1

1. **in** · the evenings draw in = it gets dark earlier.
2. **of** · a creature of habit.
3. **notoriously** · notorious → notoriously.
4. **had** · Hardly had I… when… (inversion).
5. **disorder** · seasonal affective disorder (SAD).
6. **disappointing** · disappoint → disappointing.
7. **down** · get down to = start doing seriously.
8. **up** · whip up = make quickly.
9. **of** · a riot of colour.
10. **do** · Rarely do we… (inversion).

Like the exam: Vocabulary

1. **shrouded** · shrouded in fog/mist/mystery.
2. **nip** · a nip in the air = it feels cold.
3. **shortening** · short → shortening (noun).
4. **predictable** · predict → predictable.

Like the exam: Grammar

1. **sooner had i got** · No sooner had I… than…
2. **rarely do i sleep** · Rarely do I… (inversion).
3. **to** · be used to + -ing.
4. **as** · Strange as it may seem…

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Transcripts (only if you cannot listen)

Transcript 1 · Halloween and the Castanyada

Emma: Welcome back to Culture Bites. Today: where do two famous autumn celebrations come from? Let’s start with Halloween.

Sam: Halloween comes from an old Celtic festival called Samhain. It took place in Ireland and Scotland more than two thousand years ago, at the end of the harvest and the start of winter.

Emma: And people believed that on that night, the spirits of the dead came back.

Sam: Exactly. So people used to light bonfires and wear masks to hide from the spirits. And here’s a surprise: they didn’t use pumpkins. They used to carve turnips!

Emma: Turnips? So where do the pumpkins come from?

Sam: In the 1800s, many Irish people moved to the United States. Pumpkins were bigger and easier to carve, so the tradition changed.

Emma: Now let’s go to Catalonia. On the same night, the thirty-first of October, many families celebrate the Castanyada.

Sam: It’s the night before All Saints’ Day, on the first of November. On that day, many people visit the cemetery and remember family members who have died.

Emma: So where do the chestnuts come from?

Sam: People say that, a long time ago, bell ringers rang the church bells all night for the dead. They ate roasted chestnuts to keep warm and get energy.

Emma: And chestnuts and sweet potatoes are autumn food. It’s harvest time, so they’re easy to find.

Sam: Then there are panellets: little round sweets made with almonds, sugar and pine nuts. Many families make them at home together.

Emma: And in the streets you can see castanyeres, women who sell roasted chestnuts in paper cones. At school, someone often dresses up as one.

Sam: So both celebrations happen on the same night, and both are about the dead and the end of the harvest. But they feel very different!

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